

Giona Granchelli

Engineering Chapter Lead | AI Platforms
Agentic Systems & Distributed
Architecture

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Engineering Chapter Lead and hands-on AI platform engineer in regulated banking, combining people leadership, enterprise delivery, and deep software architecture expertise. Copilot Champion and AI adoption lead at ABN AMRO; author of a governed multi-agent JVM runtime with approval controls and auditable execution. Strong background in LLM/RAG/agentic systems, distributed systems, Azure/Kubernetes, and secure production engineering.

Core Skills

AI & GenAI Engineering	LLM systems, multi-agent orchestration, RAG and vector retrieval, prompt/context engineering, LLM evaluation and benchmarking, fine-tuning (QLoRA), self-hosted inference, Python for evaluation and pipeline tooling
AI Governance & Compliance	Approval controls, auditable execution, security-by-design, risk-aware AI adoption, regulated financial environments
Enterprise AI Integration	API-driven model integration, portable provider abstraction, enterprise Copilot/IDE bridging, agentic coding workflows, SDLC integration
Backend & Distributed Systems	Java, Kotlin, Spring Boot, REST APIs, microservices, Kafka, CQRS, event-driven architecture, gRPC, data pipelines
Cloud & Platform	Kubernetes, Docker, Azure AKS, AWS, CI/CD, observability, reliability engineering, developer platforms
Leadership & Delivery	Engineering chapter leadership, talent development, architecture reviews, RFC-style communication, cross-team enablement, delivery performance management

Professional Experience

- Oct 2024 - Now **Chapter Lead Java & VueJS | Software Engineer IV, ABN AMRO - BCDB, Amsterdam, Netherlands**
- Copilot Champion & AI Adoption Lead. Engineering leadership:** lead the Java & Vue chapter of approximately 45 engineers across 5 teams, accountable for engineering capability, technical standards, and cross-team delivery; coach and develop engineers, contribute to performance management and hiring processes, run architecture reviews, and translate priorities into executable delivery plans in partnership with Product, Architecture, Security, and Risk.
- Established a shared repository of reusable agentic workflows for backend, frontend, and infrastructure teams, bringing governed AI-assisted engineering into everyday delivery.
 - Built the governance framework underpinning all agentic workflows: approval controls, auditable execution, and governed workflows with human-in-the-loop review.
 - Migrated 10 legacy applications (old Java, Struts, Spring Boot) using an agentic migration workflow, cutting an estimated 18+ months of effort to approximately 4 months.
 - Built agentic workflows integrating Azure DevOps for incident investigation and management, and an end-to-end software-delivery workflow that uses requirements and work-item context to generate and refine stories, implement changes, open PRs, perform reviews, and update engineering systems.
 - Led modernization initiatives for legacy services, defining migration paths toward cloud-native architectures on Azure AKS.
 - Designed Kubernetes-based platform patterns, CI/CD pipelines, and developer tooling to standardize containerization and deployment across teams.
 - Built and improved reconciliation jobs validating financial data consistency across multiple banking systems in a regulated environment.
 - Stack: Kubernetes, Azure, AKS, Azure DevOps, Java, TypeScript, Kafka, agentic AI workflows

Sep 2020 - Sep 2024	Full-stack Software Engineer IV, ABN AMRO - Strategy and Innovation, Amsterdam, Netherlands PayDay: core engineer for a fintech platform enabling instant payouts for gig-economy workers and freelancers. - Designed and implemented Kotlin and Spring Boot backend services for payment and payout workflows in a regulated financial environment. - Contributed to architecture decisions around transaction handling, system integration, and scalable service boundaries. - Delivered distributed services supporting financial transactions, workflow reliability, and user-facing product capabilities across backend, frontend, and mobile layers. - Stack: Kotlin, Spring Boot, Vue.js, Android, Docker, Kubernetes, AWS S3, PostgreSQL, GitLab CI
May 2020 - Jul 2020	Software Engineer, Ximedes, Haarlem, Netherlands Project for the Dutch public transportation sector (NS): end-to-end solution enabling travel with QR codes instead of conventional tickets. - Built backend and integration components for ticketing workflows; contributed real-time features using WebSockets. - Stack: Kotlin, Ktor, REST, WebSocket, ReactJS, TypeScript, Redis
Oct 2019 - Apr 2020	Full Stack Developer, BLOX - BTC Direct, Amsterdam / Nijmegen, Netherlands Cryptocurrency trading platform serving approximately 500k daily users. - Maintained and extended microservices for trading, account management, and analytics on a distributed event-driven architecture (Axon Framework, CQRS). - Improved stability and performance across multiple backend services. - Stack: Java 8, Kotlin, Spring Boot, REST, gRPC, Axon Framework, Node.js, ReactJS, MariaDB, Docker, Kubernetes, GitLab CI
Jan 2019 - Sep 2019	Senior Software Developer, WoodWing B.V., Zaandam, Netherlands Elvis, a scalable distributed Digital Asset Management system for creating, managing, and distributing digital assets. - Implemented an SSO solution integrating third-party and internal applications (AWS Cognito, Okta) and helped split a monolith by extracting auth capabilities. - Worked with a custom CQRS-style approach built around a modified use of Elasticsearch. - Stack: Java 8, Spring Framework, Elasticsearch, AWS, Jenkins, Docker, REST, AngularJS, Node.js, Okta
Jul 2017 - Jan 2019	Full Stack Developer, Trifork B.V., Amsterdam, Netherlands Multiple projects in small agile consultancy teams, combining backend delivery, frontend work, and rapid onboarding into new domains. - Contributed to IBE, a cloud-based teacher-student exam platform used in Switzerland; migrated and rebuilt CI/CD pipelines from Jenkins to GitLab. - Stack: J2EE, Kotlin, Spring Boot, REST, gRPC, Axon Framework, Node.js, ReactJS, Docker, Kubernetes, Jenkins, GitLab CI
Oct 2016 - Mar 2017	Research Scholarship: Tactics (EU project), University of L'Aquila, L'Aquila, Italy European project Tactics in collaboration with Thales Chieti and Finmeccanica (Leonardo): applying SOAP technology over a new ZigBee-based military tactical network for NATO troops. Built SOA-based services on top of new-generation tactical networks; worked on J2EE, Spring Framework, Spring Boot, SOAP, REST, Hibernate, JQuery, DDS, WebDDS.
Mar 2016 - Sep 2016	Research Scholarship: USRA, University of L'Aquila, L'Aquila, Italy Design and implementation of an enterprise system for the rebuilding of L'Aquila after the earthquake, in collaboration with USRA (Ufficio Speciale Ricostruzione dell'Aquila): the application handles the complex process of inspection, review, request, classification, and refund of real estate after a natural disaster. Developed the application from scratch. Stack: J2EE, Hibernate, Spring Framework, Maven, SVN, REST, JQuery, MySQL, HTML5, CSS3
Jun 2015 - Jan 2016	Research Scholarship: Regione Abruzzo, University of L'Aquila, L'Aquila, Italy Design and implementation of the website and cross-platform mobile app for Regione Abruzzo for Expo Milano 2015. Stack: PHP, MySQL, HTML5, CSS3, Backbone.js, Node.js, Cordova, REST
2013 - 2015	Web Developer, Freelance, Pescara, Italy Design and development of websites for local businesses. Stack: PHP, Java (J2EE), JavaScript, HTML5, CSS3, MySQL

Selected AI Platform Work

TramAI (open source, Apache-2.0)	Author and maintainer of a JVM runtime for governed AI applications: portable model providers, approval controls, auditable execution, and multi-agent workflows for production systems (tramai.dev , github.com/GionaGranchelli/tramAI).
LLM Operations & Evaluation	Operate self-hosted inference and benchmarking infrastructure (llama.cpp, GPU workstations); evaluate and compare local model variants; build fine-tuning pipelines for domain-specific assistants.
IntelliAiBridge	IntelliJ Platform integration enabling approved agentic tooling to use enterprise Copilot capabilities while preserving enterprise authentication, authorization, and network/data boundaries (AiBridge Plugin for JetBrains IDEs, JetBrains Marketplace: AiBridge).
RAG & Retrieval (QMD/OpenClaw)	Built a local Query-Markdown RAG system providing surgical retrieval over thousands of personal and project documents; researched multi-model orchestration on a Kotlin Multiplatform/Ktor control surface to keep LLM context high-precision.
Constant Labs (constant-labs.com)	Founder of an independent software studio delivering custom AI agents, voice-agent demonstrations, and workflow automation for European businesses.
WhichDistro (whichdistro.com)	Deterministic, schema-driven Linux distribution picker: turns user preferences into an explicit, transparent recommendation flow rather than a vague quiz (Nuxt 3, TypeScript, Zod).

Talks & Teaching

June 2026	Guest lecturer, Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam (VU Amsterdam): industry lecture on AI-assisted and agentic software engineering.
2026	Speaker, Ktconf 2026 (Kotlin conference).

Education

Sep 2015 - Mar 2017	Master Degree in Computer Science , <i>University of L'Aquila</i> , L'Aquila (AQ), Italy, maximum score, cum laude Thesis: Architecture Recovery of Microservice-based Systems.
Dec 2013 - Jun 2014	First Level Postgraduate Master Degree in Web Technologies , <i>University of L'Aquila</i> , L'Aquila (AQ), Italy
Sep 2009 - Jul 2013	Bachelor Degree in Computer Science , <i>University of L'Aquila</i> , L'Aquila (AQ), Italy, 99/110 Thesis: Automation control and reachable degree of automation through usage of commercial drones.

Publications

- [1] MicroART: A Software Architecture Recovery Tool for Maintaining Microservice-based Systems. In Proceedings of the 14th International Conference on Software Architecture (ICSA). IEEE, 2017.
- [2] Towards Recovering the Software Architecture of Microservice-based Systems. In IEEE International Workshop on Architecting with MicroServices (AMS), April 2017.